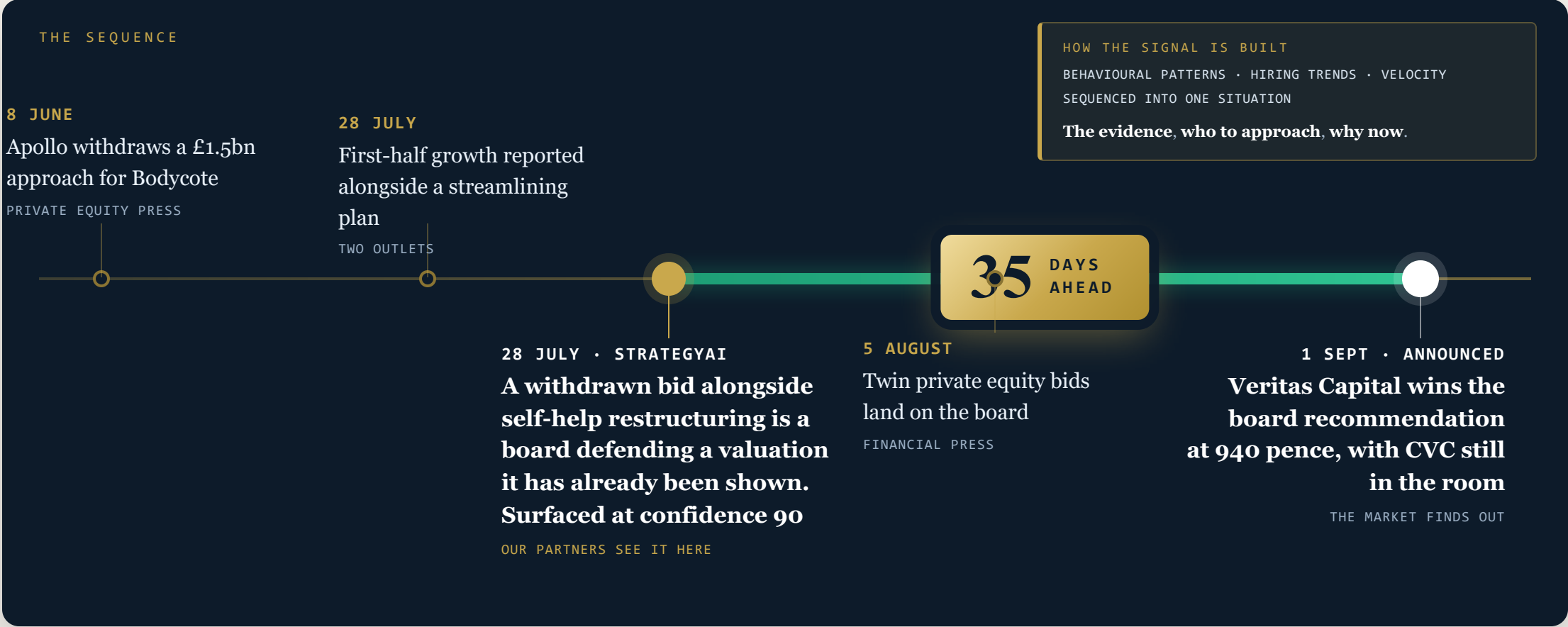


A bidder walked away from Bodycote. We read that as the opening, not the close.

Apollo pulled a £1.5bn approach on 8 June and the market filed it as a story that ended. **A withdrawn bid is the one public confirmation that a board has seen a price and refused it.** Eighty-five days later a contested process settled at 940 pence.



FOUND • SEQUENCED • SURFACED • THEN HANDED OVER WITH THE PEOPLE TO CALL

01

We found it

8 JUNE • 85 DAYS OUT

A withdrawn approach, filed by most readers as a story that ended. It is the only public proof that a board has been shown a number and turned it down.

02

We sequenced it

WITHDRAWN, THEN DEFENDED

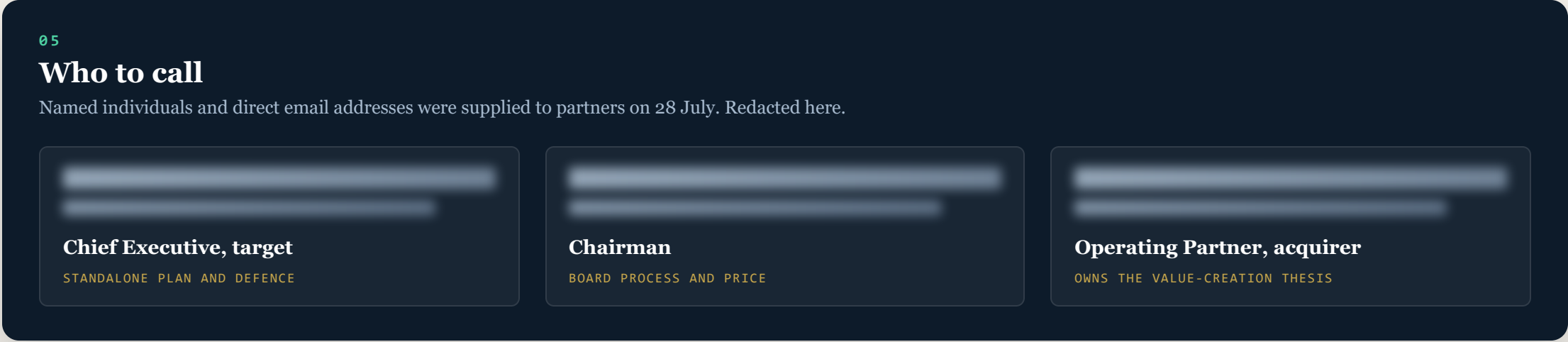
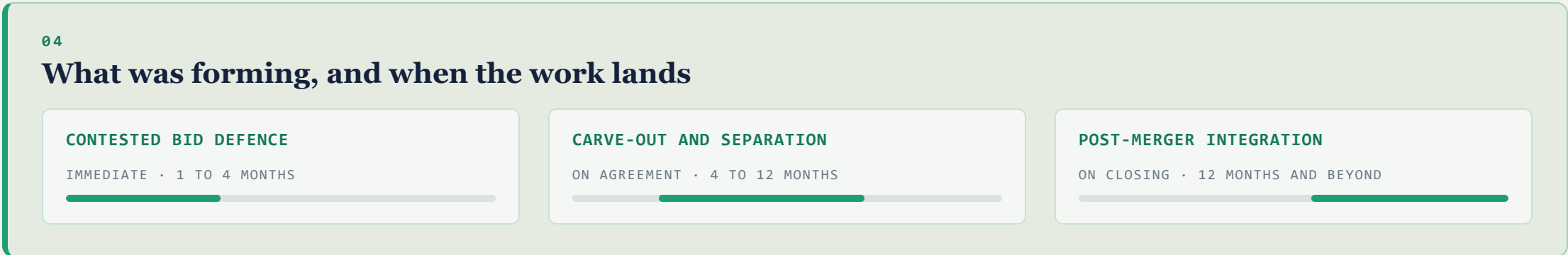
The withdrawal, the streamlining plan and the twin bids are one situation held together, not three unrelated items about a heat-treatment group.

03

We told you

28 JULY • 35 DAYS AHEAD

On the board at confidence 90 with the evidence and the window, before a contested process priced it at a 940 pence recommendation.



BEHAVIOUR PATTERNS MAPPED ACROSS 15,000+ AWARDED MANDATES AND 55,000 TRACKED SIGNALS